

Instance Methods

Now we will discuss method but the aim will be to focus on the instance method. First, let's see what is meant by method is. Methods are nothing but functions that are included in the class definition. When we create a method associated with an instance then that particular method must go with that particular instance only. We can not use a method outside the instance to which it is attached. We can only do that if we use a function outside a class.

Now let us go through the instance methods in detail. The instance methods are always declared without the static keyword. One thing that we always should remember is that this instance method is always attached to the instances of a class and it is not attached to a class as a whole. These are extremely useful when implementing functionality that can affect individual instances of a class.

If we look at the body of an instance method we will find that the static as well as the instance variables are in scope. This indicates that by using just a simple identifier we can refer to the variables that are defined in the same class.

Example

Let us look at an example of a class, i.e, Customized Array where the Array class is extended. Here a static variable name, i.e., arrayCounting Total is defined by the CustomizedArray class. The total number of class instances can be tracked by this. The arrayNumbering is also an instance variable that can track the order of the creation of the instances. Here the getPosition() instance method can return the values of the variable. Look at the script below:

```
public class CustomizedArray extends Array
{
    public static var arrayCountingTotal:int = 0;
    public var arrayNumbering:int;
    public function CustomizedArray()
```